

you learn how to make your font. In the next part, we'll learn how to use Illustrator to create a font.

How to get your letters and Illustrator files ready:

Step 1

Now we'll learn how to use Illustrator to make a font. We like to prepare my imported image file before we start making vector versions of our letterforms. We drew the letters in Adobe Photoshop. Open the jpeg file in Adobe Illustrator. In the Image Trace panel, you may want to change the following settings:

- **Preset:** Custom
- **View:** Tracing result
- **Mode:** Black and White
- **Threshold:** 168

If you have Preview turned on, your drawing will be turned into a vector image right away when you click Trace.

Step 2:

Pick the image you just traced and go to Object> Expand. It will make vector objects out of your traced image. Separate the things and use the Magic Wand Tool to pick out the ones with white fill. Delete these so that only the black letters are left.

Step 3:

Start a new file. Ours was sized to what we thought was the best size for the biggest letterform we wanted to make: 0.55 in by 1.26 in. Of course, you can pick the correct file size for your needs.

How to put your letterforms in order

Step 1

Now we'll keep learning how to use Illustrator to make your fonts. Bring in or copy and paste your letterform group into your New Document. Separate them so you can control each object on its own. We put Grid lines on top of our Artboard to help show where each part of our letterform set ends and begins. Uppercase and lowercase letters will have their tops and bottoms marked by the lines.